

Daily Opening Checklist

Sample document. Tap and Burger, front of house and back of house

Prepared for Mark Strazisar

Tap & Burger | Front of House and Back of House

This is a sample deliverable built for a casual, multi location burger and beer concept. It is a complete daily opening checklist a team can follow every morning to open clean, safe, and ready. It also works as a template. Replace the concept name, the times, the equipment, and the point of sale name with the real ones, and it is ready to print and laminate.

How to use this checklist

Each section has an owner. The opening manager owns the whole open and signs off at the end. Every person initials their own section as they complete it. Anything broken, missing, or unsafe gets written in the issues box at the bottom and reported to the manager before doors open.

The goal is simple. When the first guest walks in, the building is clean, the team is briefed, the food is prepped, the beer is cold and pouring, and nothing is a surprise.

Suggested timing for an 11:00 open is shown next to each section. Adjust to your hours.

1. Opening manager, arrive by 9:00

The manager sets the tone for the whole day. Do these first.

- ☐ Disarm alarm and unlock the staff entrance
- ☐ Walk the building for overnight issues: leaks, pests, temperature, smell, security
- ☐ Turn on lights, music at open level, and HVAC
- ☐ Check that the building is at the right temperature
- ☐ Pull the previous night's closing report and confirm closing was done right
- ☐ Read any notes from the closing shift
- ☐ Check the reservation or large party book for today
- ☐ Count and set the point of sale drawers; record starting cash
- ☐ Confirm the schedule and that all opening staff are present or accounted for
- ☐ Review the 86 list and today's features with the kitchen
- ☐ Check that all opening staff are in clean uniform and ready

Manager initials: _____

2. Front of house, dining room, by 10:15

- ☐ Unlock and prop interior doors as needed for setup
- ☐ Turn on all dining room and patio lights to open level
- ☐ Sweep and mop or confirm floors are clean and dry
- ☐ Wipe and level every table; check for wobble and sticky spots
- ☐ Set every table to standard: clean condiments, full napkin holders, settings
- ☐ Wipe down chairs, booths, and seat cushions
- ☐ Clean and stock the host stand: menus, kids menus, pens, to go menus
- ☐ Confirm menus are clean and current, no stains or old inserts
- ☐ Check and clean windows, entry glass, and front door handles
- ☐ Set up and wipe patio furniture if open; check umbrellas and heaters
- ☐ Confirm restrooms are clean, stocked with paper and soap, floors dry
- ☐ Check that all lights, signs, and the open sign work

Front of house initials: _____

3. Server stations and service areas, by 10:30

- ☐ Stock clean rolled silverware to par
- ☐ Stock clean glassware: water, pint, and specialty glasses
- ☐ Fill ice wells and confirm the ice machine is working and clean
- ☐ Brew coffee and stock tea, sugars, and creamers
- ☐ Fill water pitchers and stock lemons if used
- ☐ Stock to go boxes, bags, lids, and utensils
- ☐ Stock clean rags and sanitizer buckets at correct strength
- ☐ Confirm point of sale terminals are on and printers have paper
- ☐ Test that one full order rings and prints to the kitchen correctly
- ☐ Stock condiments, kids supplies, high chairs, and booster seats

Server station initials: _____

4. Bar opening, by 10:30

- [] Turn on bar lights, equipment, and television or screens if used
- [] Check that all beers on tap pour correctly; pour a test taste of each line
- [] Note any line that pours foamy or is kicked; update the 86 list
- [] Confirm CO2 and keg levels; change any near empty kegs
- [] Stock and fill all ice wells
- [] Stock liquor, beer, wine, and mixers to par
- [] Cut and stock fresh garnishes: limes, lemons, and any others
- [] Wash, sanitize, and stock all bar glassware
- [] Set up and test the bar point of sale and card reader
- [] Wipe down the bar top, rail, stools, and speed wells
- [] Confirm the bar is stocked with napkins, straws, picks, and coasters
- [] Count and set the bar cash drawer; record starting cash

Bar initials: _____

5. Back of house, line and stations, by 10:15

- [] Turn on hood vents first, then grill, flat top, fryers, and ovens
- [] Confirm fryers are filled with clean oil at the right level
- [] Bring all equipment to temperature and confirm with a thermometer
- [] Check that all coolers and freezers are holding safe temperatures
- [] Record all cooler, freezer, and hot hold temperatures on the log
- [] Set up each station with clean cutting boards, knives, and tools
- [] Stock each station to par from prep and walk in
- [] Label and date all prepped items; confirm nothing is past date
- [] Pull and rotate product using first in first out
- [] Set up sanitizer buckets at correct strength and place test strips out
- [] Confirm hand wash sinks are stocked with soap and paper towels
- [] Set up the expo and window: tickets, plates, garnish, heat lamps

Line initials: _____

6. Back of house, prep and walk in, by 10:30

- ☐ Review prep list against today's expected volume and features
- ☐ Confirm burger patties, buns, and proteins are thawed and prepped to par
- ☐ Prep produce, sauces, and dressings to par
- ☐ Confirm all items are labeled with name and date
- ☐ Organize the walk in: clean, rotated, nothing on the floor, raw below ready to eat
- ☐ Check the 86 list against actual stock and update it
- ☐ Confirm enough fries, sides, and shareables are prepped
- ☐ Take out trash and break down boxes from any morning delivery

Prep initials: _____

7. Dish and sanitation, by 10:30

- ☐ Turn on and fill the dish machine; confirm wash and rinse temperatures
- ☐ Confirm the dish machine sanitizer or rinse is working; record temperature
- ☐ Set up the three compartment sink: wash, rinse, sanitize at correct strength
- ☐ Stock clean dish racks and confirm clean glassware and plates are put away
- ☐ Confirm floor mats are clean and laid down safely
- ☐ Confirm trash and recycling bins are lined and not overflowing

Dish initials: _____

8. Final pre open walkthrough, by 10:50

The manager walks the building one last time with the opening team.

- ☐ Dining room looks guest ready: clean, set, lit, comfortable temperature
- ☐ Restrooms clean and fully stocked
- ☐ Bar ready, all taps confirmed pouring, garnishes cut
- ☐ Kitchen at temperature, stations stocked, expo ready
- ☐ All temperature logs completed and signed
- ☐ 86 list is accurate and posted where the team can see it
- ☐ Pre shift meeting held: features, 86 list, large parties, any focus for the day
- ☐ All staff clocked in, in uniform, and in position
- ☐ Music, lights, and patio set to open level
- ☐ Front door unlocked and open sign on at opening time

Manager final walkthrough initials: _____

Issues and follow up

Write anything broken, missing, low, or unsafe here. The manager reviews this before doors open and follows up.

Issue Reported to Status

_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Daily open sign off

Date: _____ Day: _____ Weather or events affecting volume: _____

Opening manager: _____ Time open completed: _____

Everything on this checklist is complete and the building is guest ready: Yes [☐] No [☐]

If no, what is outstanding and the plan:

Open clean, open safe, open ready. A good open makes the whole day easier.